

like Chromebook. Of course, do not even think of getting a MacBook Air at this price.

Second biggest advantage of getting a Chromebook is that you can start working on it almost instantly. You just need to turn it on, log onto your Google account, get on with your bookmarks and extensions and get going with your Chromebook. You cannot get the same pleasure even on your iPad and Nexus 7, because both the devices will run the mobile version of Chrome and you will not be able to access your extensions there.

Chromebooks can be switched on in less than 10 seconds. These are full-fledged laptops, with proper keyboards and built-in video chat cameras. They can support many USB devices. Some of the Chromebooks also have an HDMI port along with a Secure Digital memory card for expandable storage facility. Also, other users can comfortably use your Chromebook without peeping into your account, yet signing into their separate accounts.

Another advantage that Chromebooks bring along is their regular software updates. Chromebooks update themselves regularly. Google states that the multi-layer security it has rendered to Chrome OS almost eliminates the need of an additional anti-virus, which is a cost-saving area.

Disadvantages of buying a Chromebook

Users of Chromebooks need to be very well planned for using their device smoothly on the go. If you are boarding a flight for a long journey, you can use your Chromebook even without a Wi-Fi connection provided you store the files in Google Drive beforehand and enable the offline mode of the drive too. You also have to perform an offline sync before boarding the flight. Alternately, you can use an SD card to store all your data and use it with your Chromebook while you are travelling.

For all those working on a specialised software or technology, Chrome-

books are surely not for them. Like a heavy photoshop user cannot resort to a Chromebook. Yes, there are many image-editing apps in the Chrome web apps collection, but it can eventually be a frustrating experience for someone looking for extensive usage of the editing technology.

Factors to look for while buying a Chromebook:

Cost. Since Chromebooks are cost-friendly and affordable, you can look for a variety of models available in the basic range. But you can buy an 'all-around' Chromebook experience at a higher cost (US\$ 1300) with Chromebook Pixel. Chromebook Pixel has the Chrome OS at its best and sports a high-end hardware. With its luxurious design and 4.3-million-pixel touch-enabled display, Chromebook Pixel is surely a user's delight.

Design and build quality. Almost all the Chromebooks offer the same kind of features, barring the design and build quality. Some companies offering Chromebooks have worked extensively on coming up with a sleek and minimalist design. HP Chromebook 11 is one such example of a sleek device. The build quality is also something that you should pay much stress on.

Performance levels. If you are looking for high-level performance, go for a powerful variant of the device. Of course, you cannot match the power levels of Chromebook Pixel at a reasonable price, but there are some high-end models available for you to explore.

Chromebooks with 4GB RAM and new-age chipsets (such as Haswell-based ones) are available in the market, which offer better performance than the entry-level systems. The entry-level Chromebooks provide very basic computing needs. However, the power Chromebooks could be a bit bulky and heavy, as compared to their sleek siblings, but who minds if they are truly worth the money. ●

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